Fern & Fine Print

INSURANCE EDUCATION, MINUS THE HEADACHE

Companion to *The Agent Check*
Facts and links checked Oct 31, 2026

The Agent Check Checklist

two calm minutes before you share anything

1 Get the basics

- ☐ Name and agency: _____
- ☐ NPN (National Producer Number) _____
- ☐ License # in *my* state _____
- ☐ Which insurance companies they represent
- ☐ How they're paid. Any fee to me? Get it **in writing** first

2 Check the license

- ☐ Open **my state's** official lookup (Lesson 4 table, or the NAIC map: content.naic.org/state-insurance-departments)
- ☐ Search by NPN or license number
- ☐ Name and city match
- ☐ Status is **Active**; expiration date is in the future
- ☐ A **health** line of authority is listed
- ☐ No actions or discipline I'm worried about

3 Check the Marketplace

- ☐ Which kind is my state? healthcare.gov/marketplace-in-your-state
- ☐ **HealthCare.gov states:** NPN + plan year **2027** on data.healthcare.gov/ab-registration-completion-list. Look for a 2027 date and NPN Valid = Y
- ☐ Not on the termination list: data.healthcare.gov/ab-suspension-and-termination-list
- ☐ **Own-Marketplace states:** find them in the Marketplace's help directory, or call and ask

4 During the conversation

- ☐ I saw the **consent** first: date, my name, their name, what, why, how long, how to cancel
- ☐ **My** phone and email are on my application (never theirs)
- ☐ I approved only the agent I chose (one-time code or link)
- ☐ I reviewed the whole application before it was submitted
- ☐ No one promised approval, a price, or "free" coverage
- ☐ I pay my premium **to the plan**, not to a person
- ☐ I had time to think and compare

! Stop signs

- ☐ Asks for my HealthCare.gov **password**, a security code, or to screen-share
- ☐ Promises a "free cash card," gifts, or guaranteed $0
- ☐ Prerecorded robocall, or "I'm from the government"
- ☐ Asks me to pay them, or to pay with gift cards
- ☐ Wants my SSN or bank info just for a price quote
- ☐ Won't give an NPN or license number
- ☐ A card, letter, or code for a plan I didn't choose

5 Something wrong?

Plan or agent changed without my OK: **Marketplace Call Center 1-800-318-2596** (TTY 1-855-889-4325), or my state-run Marketplace · Agent conduct: my **state insurance department** · Scam ads, impostors, robocalls: **ReportFraud.ftc.gov** · Identity theft: **IdentityTheft.gov**. Save screenshots and every case number.

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